

TECHMOOCHER'S PORTFOLIO

```
function techmoocher() {  
  const info = [  
    "👤 Name: Phuc (Benjamin) Nguyen",  
    "🎓 Title: Student @ VNUHCM High School for the Gifted",  
    "💖 Hobbies: Running 🏃, Cycling 🚴, Piano 🎹, Coding 👨💻",  
    "🔧 Skills: Java, Python, C++, HTML/CSS/JS, and more!",  
    '🔗 Find me at: @techmoocher',  
  ];  
}
```

More at www.techmoocher.com



PHUC NGUYEN



COMPUTER ENTHUSIAST

Hi, it's **Phuc (Benjamin) Nguyen**, a.k.a **techmoocher**. As a tech enthusiast, I'm passionate about creating widely accessible innovations that can improve people's lives.

MY WORKS



KARU THE FOX



HOMELAB



CHUOI MAN COI



HYPRLAND DOTFILES

HOMELAB

github.com/techmoocher/homelab

Overview

This project originated from my newly discovered hobby. Initially, I planned to host my cloud file storage, yet I'm hosting over 12 services.

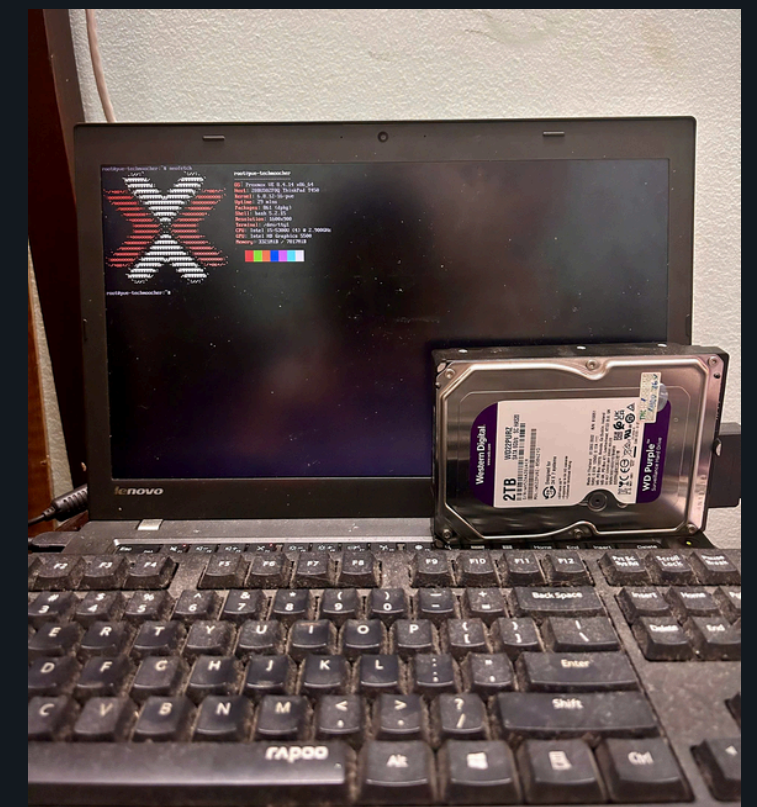
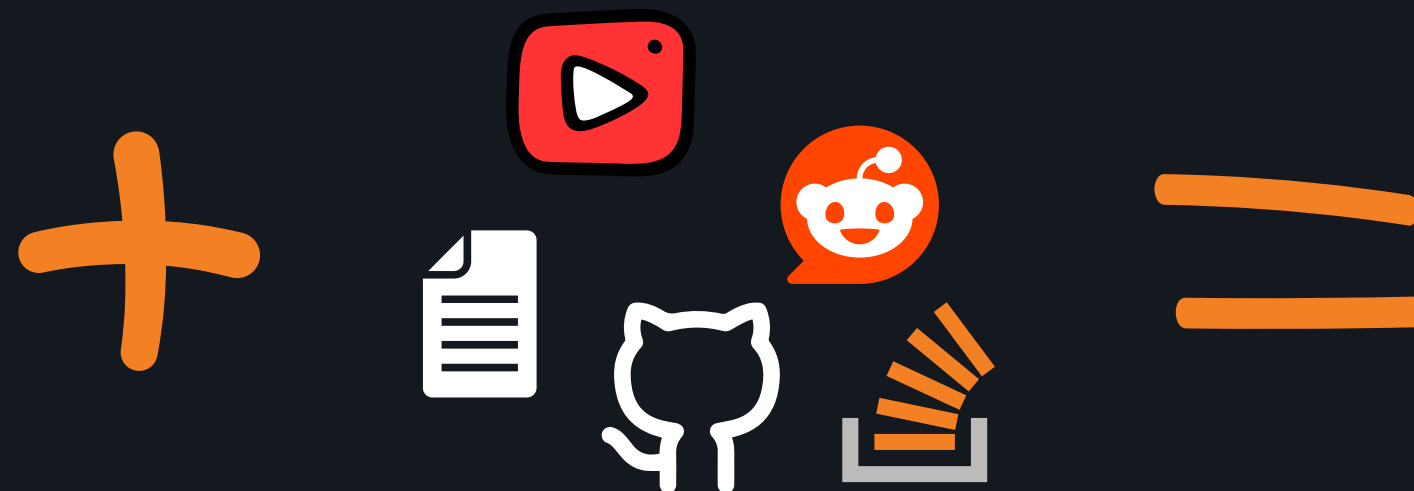
Live demo at bit.ly/techmoocher-homelab



Initially, ...

This project did not start with any sort of “intensive passion,” yet it was **inspired by my father’s complaint** about the price of Google Drive and **powered by YouTube, Reddit**, and various forums and wikis.

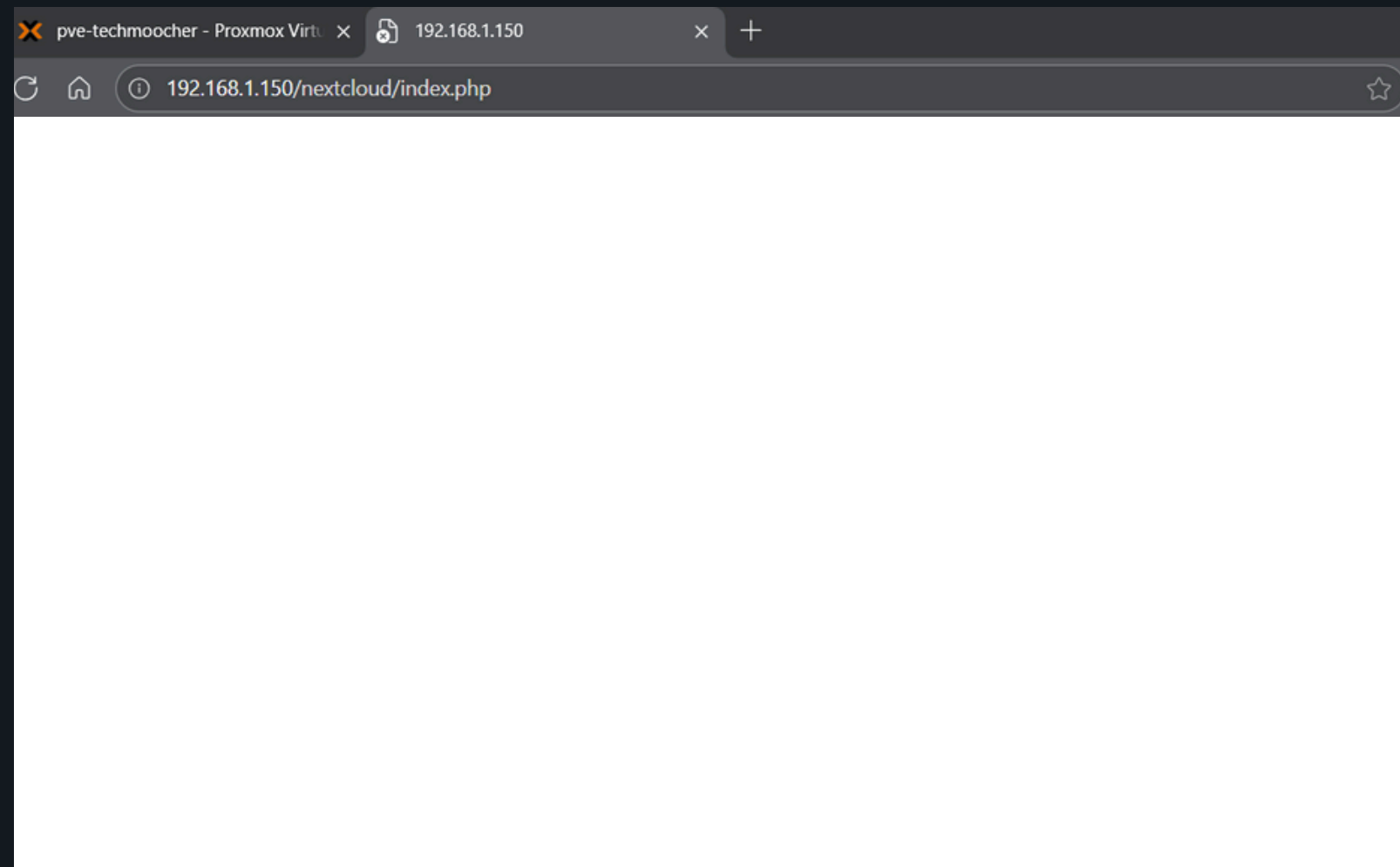
"How come 2TB of Google Drive costs that much!"
- my dad -



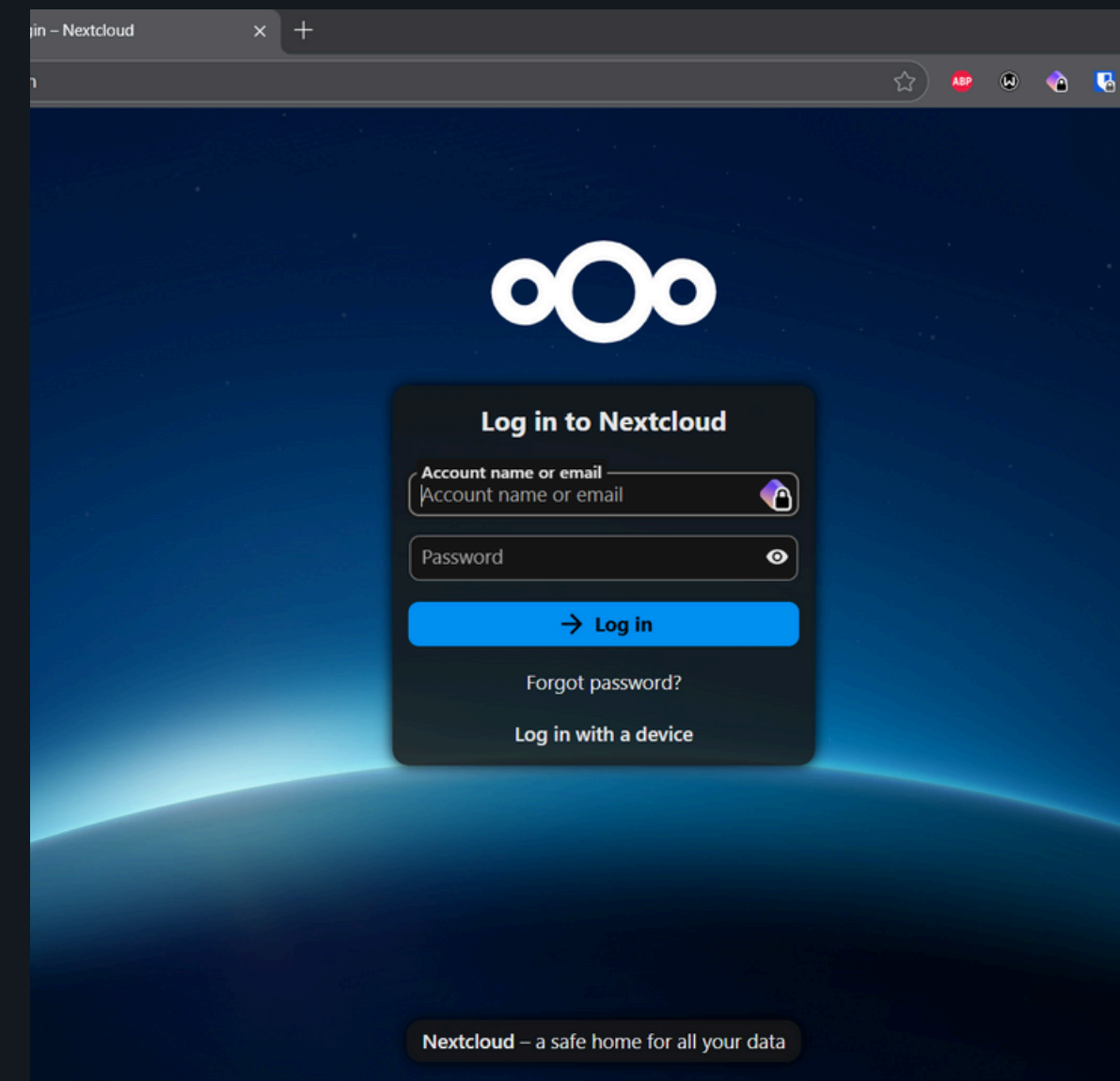
The most memorable moment was ...

Installing Nextcloud was particularly challenging, mostly due to my inexperience. **Nextcloud was the first service I attempted** to install as it could directly address my father's complaint. Despite having watched multiple tutorials, **all I got were white blank screens**. It took me a few days of researching before I identified the culprit: **a subtle PHP version incompatibility (!!!)**





Nextcloud failed to run



Finally running!!!

We now running ...

- **Family cloud storage:** My family now uses **Nextcloud** for personal files and backups.
- **Photo backup:** We no longer need Google Photos, as we can easily back up our photos with **Immich**.
- **Ad-free music streaming:** Self-hosting music with **Navidrome**.
- **Dashboard:** I'm using **the Glance Dashboard** as a multi-functional web browser start page.
- **Network-wide adblock:** Our house's network is protected from ads and trackers with **AdGuard Home**.

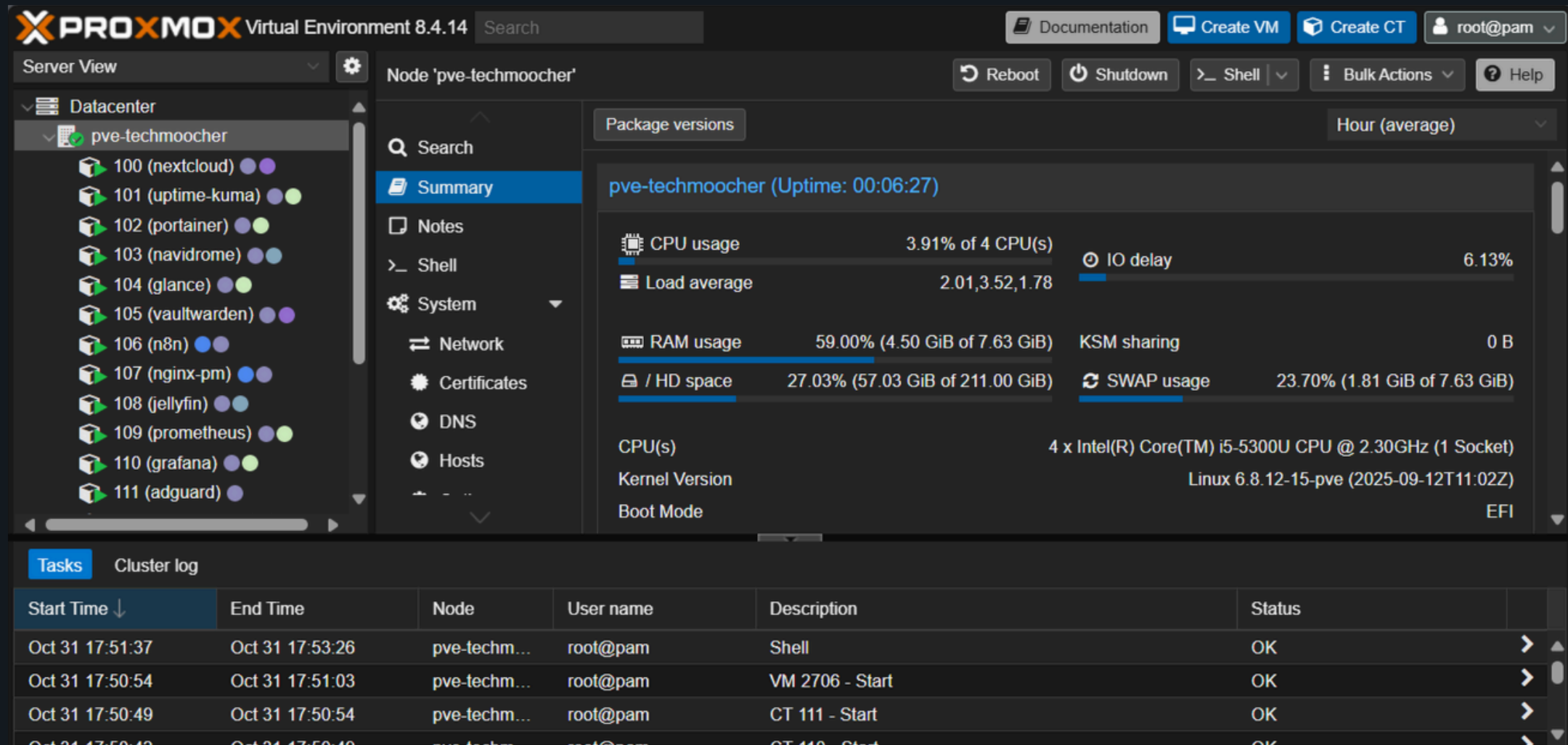
and many more coming ...

Wrapping up, ...

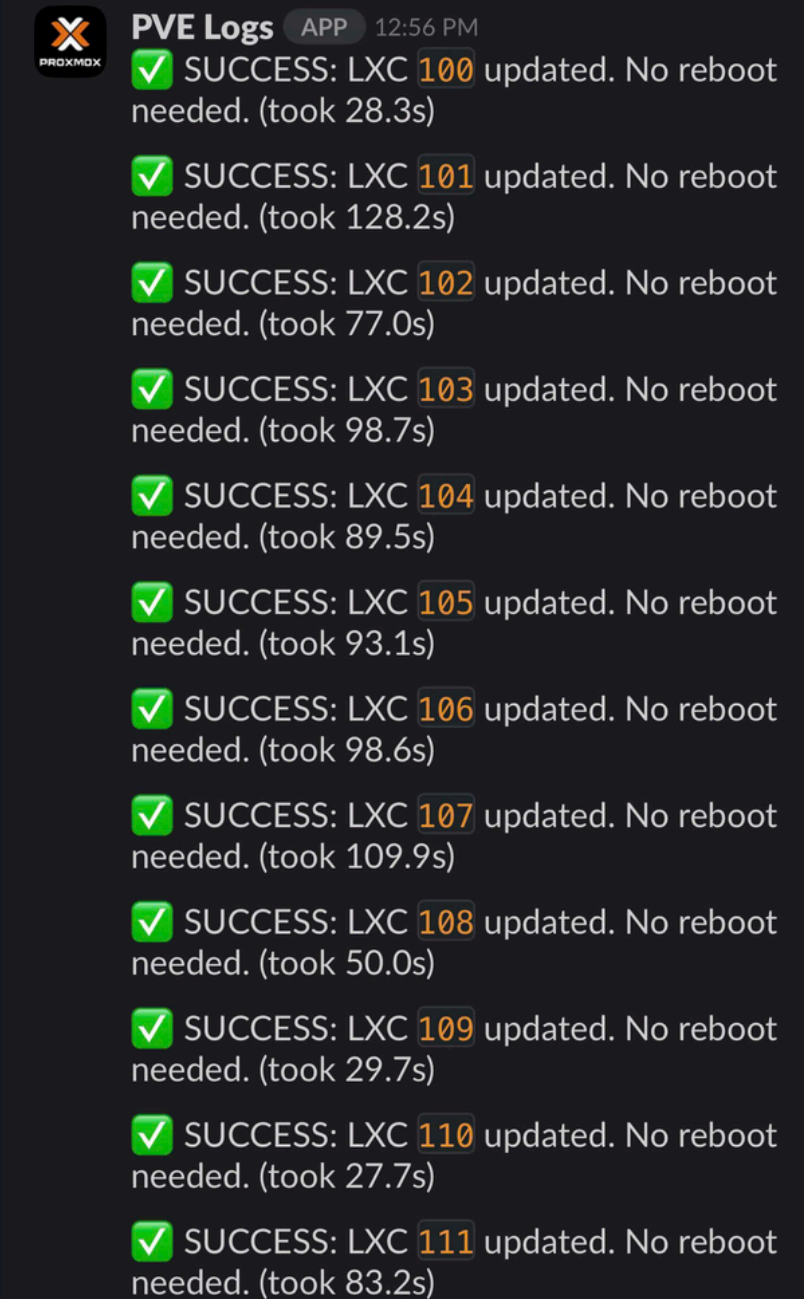
Although this project was challenging, it brought about lots of thrill. Through this, I **not only gained technical knowledge** like networking, or operating systems **but also developed my character**.

Behind the frustrating hours of **debugging** was a **thrilling process of problem-solving**. The homelab ignited in me a new passion: **utilizing technology to improve people's lives**.

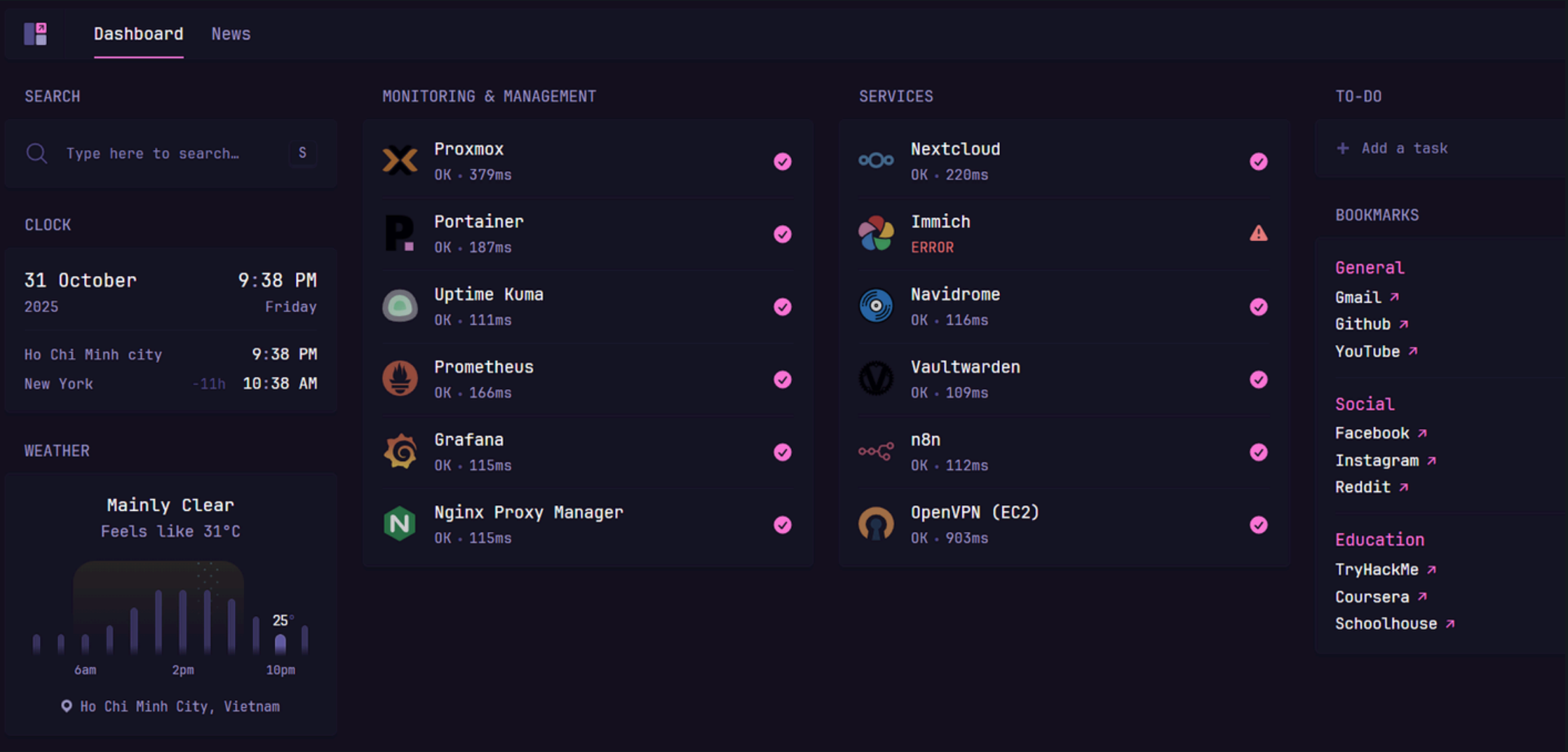
Besides, the project taught me lessons about **patience and resilience**. **Bugs were inevitable**. However, scary as they may sound, **they were valuable data point** for me to **recognize what was going wrong** and **attempting to fix that**.



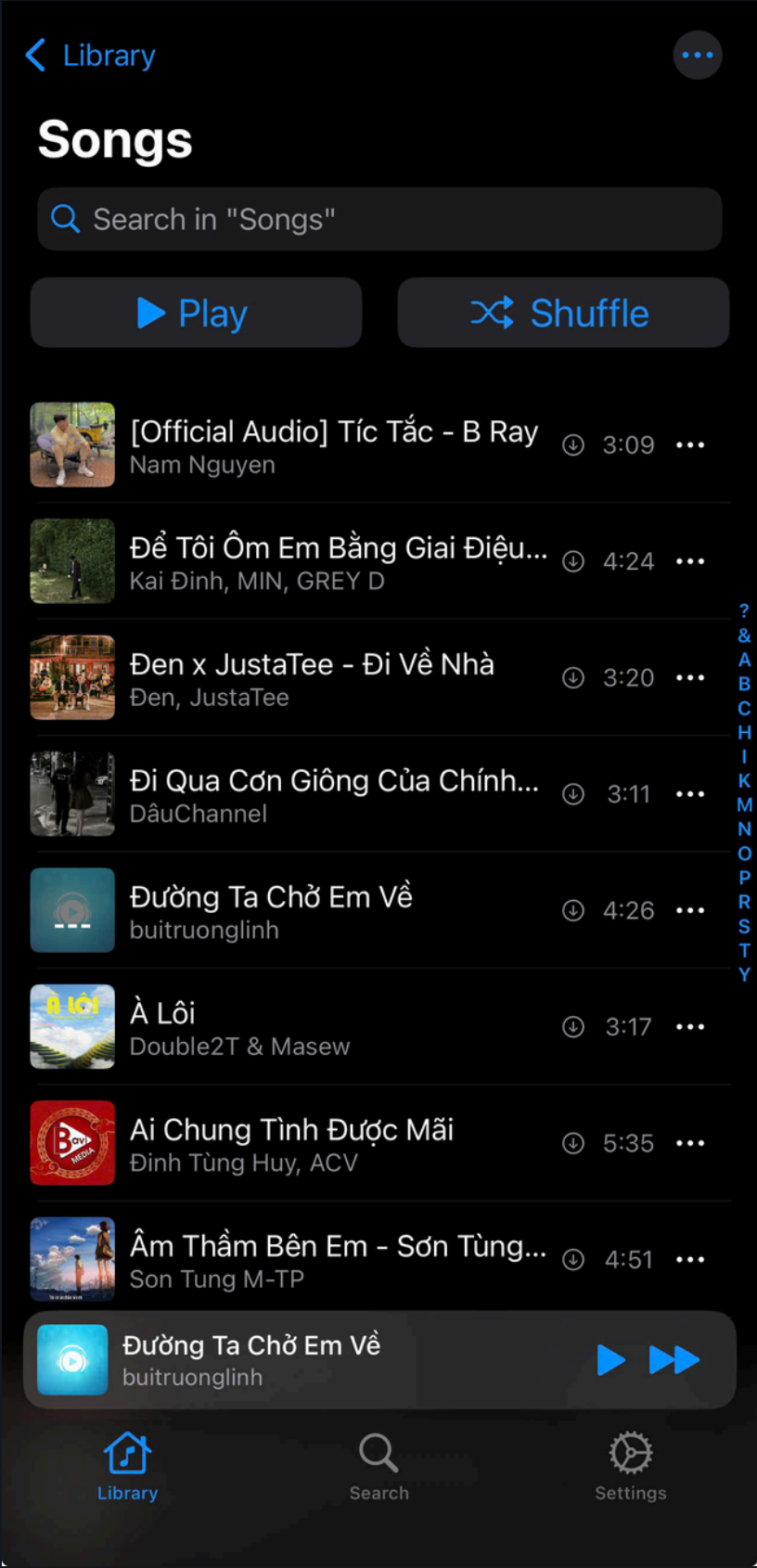
Picture 1.1. My homelab's Proxmox dashboard



Picture 1.2.
System updates through Slack



Picture 1.3. My Glance Dashboard



*Picture 1.4.
Music with Navidrome + Amperfy*

KARU THE FOX



github.com/techmoocher/Karu-the-Fox

Overview

This project aimed to create a virtual desktop pet that wanders around the bottom of the screen, keeping people relaxed and cheering them up.



Issues involved

Digital isolation and burnout from long workdays is **increasingly popular**. According to a 2024 Gallup report, **41% workers** are facing **high stress** and **1 in every 5** feels **daily loneliness**.

Solution

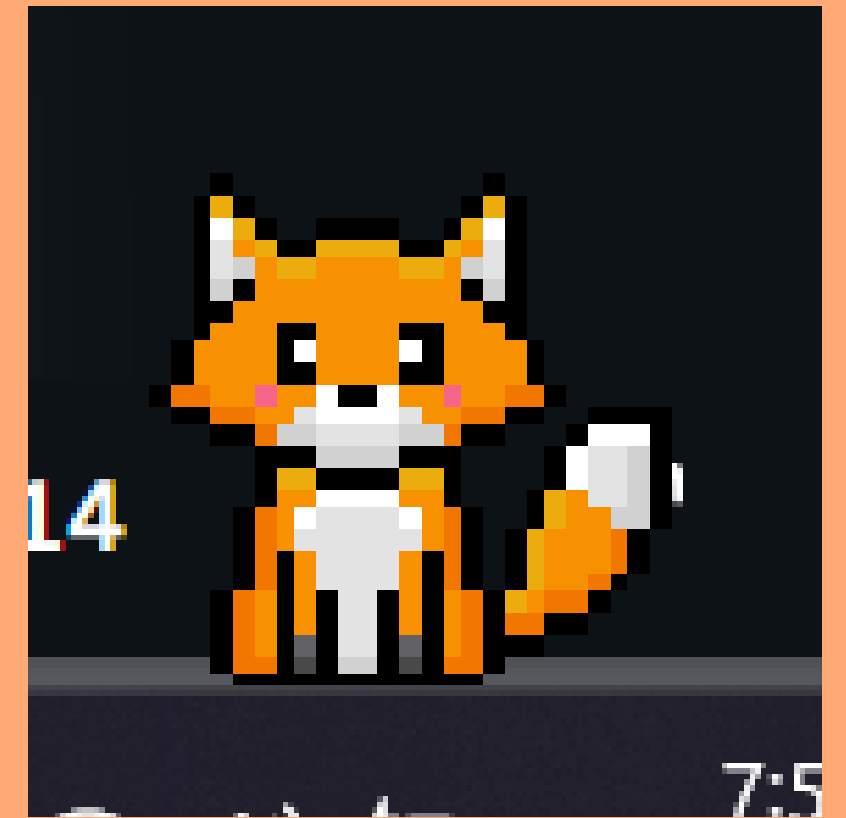
Karu the Fox is designed to provides a **supportive interactive companion** who could make those long working hours at the computer feel less stressful and lonely.



Features

- **Interactive pet:** Karu walks around, sleeps, and reacts when being dragged around.
- **Live chat:** Have a conversation with Karu, powered by Google Gemini 2.5 Flash.
- **Built-in music player:** Import and play your favorite songs directly from the app.

View live demo at bit.ly/Karu-live-demo



CHUOI MAN COI

Overview

This is a website I built to help students pursuing religious studies at my church, where we practice praying the rosary with pre-compiled guidelines.

Learn more at chuoimancoi.techmoocher.com



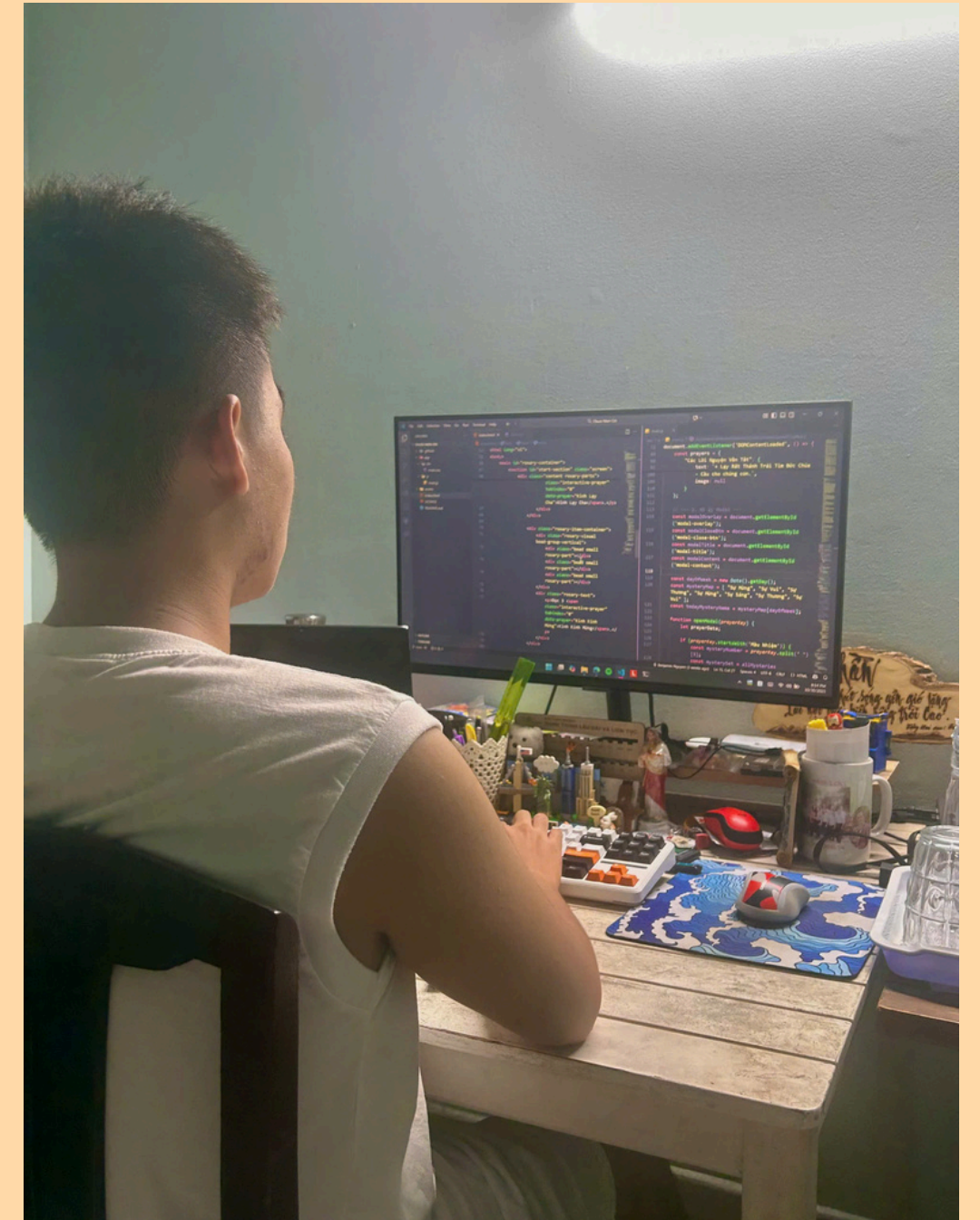
The issue involved in this project

As October arrives, the Month of the Holy Rosary, the Board of Catechism launch a campaign to **raise followers' awareness of praying the rosary**. However, due to **the lack of religious education** at home, **many struggle to practice, thus becoming unmotivated**.



Therefore,...

I developed "**Chuoi Man Coi**" — an **interactive web application**, aiming to **make the Rosary prayers more user-friendly for the digital-native generation**. The app guides users through each prayer and Mysteries, which change daily depending on the specific day of the week.



Picture 3.1. *Me developing the web*



Picture 3.2. Campaign launch



Picture 3.3. Popularize the web

		Tuần 1 + 2		Tuần 3	Tuần 4
SỐ KINH ĐỌC ĐƯỢC TRONG 1 TUẦN (HẠN CHÓT bảo số kinh là Thứ Năm 30/10)	Chiên con		500	500	2030
	Khai tâm 1		170	146	
	Khai tâm 2A				
	Khai tâm 2B	220	460	580	600
	Rước lễ 1A	780			130
	Rước lễ 1B	295	800	610	
	Rước lễ 1C			1840	
	Rước lễ 2A		296	2905	
	Rước lễ 2B	328	680	530	642
	Rước lễ 2C				
	Thêm sức 1A	372	530	429	542
	Thêm sức 1B	362		400	600
	Thêm sức 1C	26			78
	Thêm sức 2A	170	520	498	
	Thêm sức 2B	350	410		
	Thêm sức 2C	520	640	1600	1020
	Thêm sức 2D				
	Thêm sức 3			3150	
	Bao đồng 1A		810	850	
	Bao đồng 1B	5040			
	Bao đồng 2	120	93		
	Bao đồng 3	300		140	130

Picture 3.4. Prayers count logging sheet

Impacts and Results

Our campaign successfully promoted praying the Rosary, with a total of **over 37,000 individual prayers** or **~3720 completed Rosary decades** logged by **over 600 participants** at our church.

HYPRLAND DOTFILES

github.com/techmoocher/hyprland-dotfiles

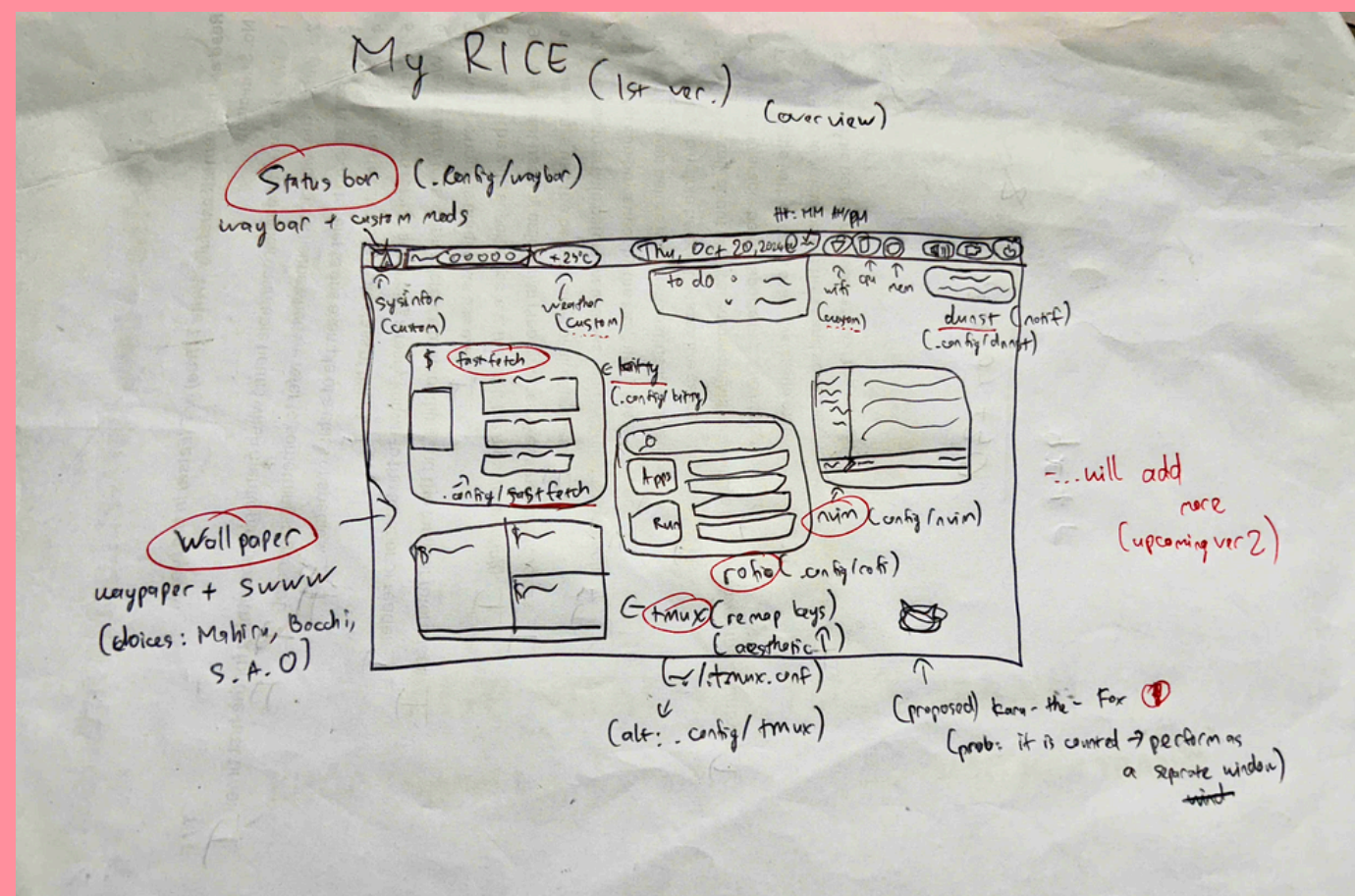


Overview

This is a personal hobby project, aiming at creating an **aesthetic and functional configuration** and styling for my desktop from ground up (also known as “**ricing**”).



Picture 4.1. desktop + fastfetch



Picture 4.2. my first planning sketch

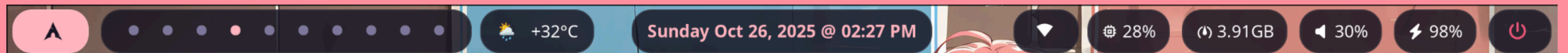
This is **my first time “ricing.”** It was **daunting**, though, as I had to **spend considerable time researching** wikis, docs, and forums, and **self-teaching new technical knowledge**. At times, I had to write my own custom set up as not everything I want is built-in.

However, this project, alongside my **Homelab**, helped me **gain deeper knowledge** about Linux, **learned to think systematically** to do the planning, and, most importantly, **learned to be patient**, as most of the times things wouldn't go as I expected.

Problems encountered (nvim + waybar)

For **Waybar** (status bar), styling and configuring built-in modules, I also had to **write my own custom modules configuration**, which was **time-consuming and frustrating** (as bugs were common).

For **Neovim** (text editor), I had to **learn to write in Lua**, with which I had not been familiar. Thus, it **took me nearly a month** trying to **pick up Lua, planning the desired features**, and **customizing pre-built plugins to match my preference**. Though my implementation is still “under construction,” experiencing Neovim was really eye-opening.



Picture 4.2. My Waybar

CONTACT

Address

66 Street No. 17, Binh Hung R.A
Binh Hung ward, Binh Chanh district
Ho Chi Minh city 700000, Viet Nam

Email

ndvphuc276@gmai.com
student230827@ptnk.edu.vn

Mobile

(+84) 90 338 1820

